

# Lina and the Moon-Pocket Picnic

*A printable 12-spread story sheet*

1. Lina's blue blanket had a pocket - just big enough for a moon-picnic. "Before the moon peeks in, I'll pack it!" she said.
2. In went one red starberry. Plip! Two yellow moon-muffins. Plop, plop! Three tiny cloud-cups. "Pick one, tuck one, moon-time fun."
3. Baby Sol toddled over. "Ba?" He reached for the pocket. Lina hugged it close. "Mine. It's my special picnic."
4. Papa dimmed the bright lamp. "Bedtime is here." "But my picnic isn't!" cried Lina. Sol reached again. "Stop!" Lina's cheeks felt hot.
5. Lina whispered, "If I share, will my whole pocket be gone?" Papa sat nearby. "You want your special thing to stay yours." Lina nodded.
6. Papa wondered, "What might one tiny moon guest need?" Lina peeked at Sol. He opened his mouth: a little round O.
7. "The pocket stays with me," Lina said. She held out one pretend starberry. "But this can be for you."
8. Sol took the biggest pretend nibble in the whole wide room. "NOMMMMM!" Lina snorted. Papa snorted. Even the moon seemed to snort.
9. "We need three moon-ready steps," Lina decided. "Wash, pajamas, story. Pick one, tuck one, moon-time fun!" Which step comes first?
10. Wash - splash! Pajamas - zip! Story - flip, flip, flip. Three steps became two, then one, then done.
11. The moon peeked in. Lina and Sol raised their cloud-cups. "To our picnic!" Lina yawned. Her busy body felt soft and slow.
12. Lina tucked a silver pretend note into her pocket: TOMORROW. Then she tucked herself beside Papa. Sol curled close. Moon high, voices low - good night, picnic. Good night, glow.

*Read aloud slowly. Pause wherever your child wants to join, notice, or wonder.*

# Tavi's Small-Step Trail

*A printable 12-spread story sheet*

- 1.** Tavi the young tortoise had an important job: carry the curly leaf banner to the pond parade. He polished his shell. He practiced his wave. Slowly, proudly, off he went.
- 2.** Drip on a fern. Drop on a rock. Drip-drop on Tavi's nose! Three ducklings marched behind him: left, right, waddle-waddle-right.
- 3.** Around the bend spread a puddle - wide as seven tortoise steps. The old dry trail was under all that wiggly water.
- 4.** Tavi stretched one long, long leg toward the middle. Sploop! Mud kissed his toes. He pulled back fast. "I can't do this!"
- 5.** His neck felt tight. His eyes felt stingy. "I'm frustrated," Tavi said. The ducklings stopped. They did not rush him.
- 6.** Pip the frog sat on a stone. "Pause. Peek. Pick one step," she said. Tavi breathed in fern-smell and breathed out: whooooo.
- 7.** They peeked. One worm wriggled on top of the wet soil. Two snails glided where the air was damp. Pip's wide back feet helped her swim. What else might rain wake up?
- 8.** Pip could leap across. BOING! Tavi almost copied her - but his feet were made for tortoise steps, not frog leaps. "I'll choose my kind of try."
- 9.** At the puddle's shallow edge, one flat stone showed through. Tavi tapped it. Steady. "Pause. Peek. Pick one step." On went one front foot.
- 10.** Tap, step. Tap, step. Tavi followed the shallow edge - not fast, not splashy, but forward. The ducklings followed his careful path. Waddle-waddle-WHEE!
- 11.** At the pond, Tavi uncurled the banner. PARADE TODAY! Pip cheered. The ducklings bowed. Tavi's muddy toes tingled with pride.
- 12.** On the way home, the puddle was still wide. Tavi was still careful. He smiled anyway. "Pause. Peek. Pick one step." Tap, step. Tap, step. Home.

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# The Turnip That Wouldn't Tip

*A printable 12-spread story sheet*

- 1.** In Grandma's garden, Mae found a turnip with a purple top, a white chin, and leaves like three green flags. "Soup for supper!" Mae cried.
- 2.** Mae wrapped both hands around the leaves. "Grip, grin - shall we begin?" She pulled high. She pulled low. The turnip did not tip.
- 3.** Goat clip-clopped over. "I have two strong horns!" Mae made room. Mae held the leaves; Goat held Mae. One, two - PULL! They landed in a soft haystack. Poof!
- 4.** Hen flapped over. "I have two scratchy feet!" Goat held Mae; Hen held Goat's tail. One, two, three - PULL! The turnip stayed. Hen's feathers stood straight up.
- 5.** "It won't listen to me!" Mae huffed. She sat beside the stubborn bump. Grandma brought the soup pot and sat too. "What is the ground telling you?" she wondered.
- 6.** A small voice squeaked, "Maybe the turnip needs a little tickle." It was Mouse. Mae blinked. Mouse was smaller than Hen, smaller than Goat, smaller than Mae's boot.
- 7.** Mae could have pulled again. Instead she asked, "Show us?" Mouse whisked dry crumbs away from the turnip's chin. Hen scratched gently. The packed soil loosened.
- 8.** Wiggle-waggle went the leaves. "It moved!" Mae made room for every helper: Mouse by the soil, Hen behind Mouse, Goat behind Hen, Mae at the back.
- 9.** One small Mouse. Two scratchy Hen feet. Three green leaves. Four friends ready. Can you whisper their pulling words? "Grip, grin - shall we begin?"
- 10.** One, two, three - PULL! The turnip tipped. The helpers flipped. Bump-bump-bump-bump! They landed in the haystack with the turnip on top like a purple hat.
- 11.** Mae hugged the enormous turnip. Then she looked at her helpers. "Our turnip," she said. Together they washed, chopped, stirred, and sniffed.
- 12.** Five bowls waited: big, little, and in-between. Mae raised her spoon. "Grip, grin - shall we dig in?" Mouse squeaked, "Now that's my kind of tip!"

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# Nora's Noticing Walk

*A printable 12-spread story sheet*

- 1.** Nora drew four empty boxes in her notebook. "One is for a blue butterfly," she said. "The other three can surprise me." Mama and little cousin Jo came too.
- 2.** Along the garden path, Nora looked high and low. Red flower, yellow flower, white flower - but no blue butterfly. Can you point to something blue?
- 3.** "BIRD!" shouted Jo. A sparrow fluttered from the fence. Nora frowned. "Now we'll never see anything." Jo's shoulders drooped.
- 4.** Mama said, "You hoped for a butterfly. Jo hoped to help. That's two big hopes." Nora's tight hands opened a little.
- 5.** At the creek path, Mama whispered, "What can we notice without chasing or touching?" Nora made up a rule: "Eyes look, ears hear, gentle hands stay near."
- 6.** A silver snail slid across a wet stone. Its soft body rode beneath a hard shell. Slowly, slowly - a shiny trail appeared. Nora marked box one with a swirl.
- 7.** Under a fallen log, a pill bug curled into a tiny gray ball when the log trembled. Nora and Jo stepped back. Soon it uncurled. Box two got a dotty circle.
- 8.** "My turn to notice?" Jo whispered. Nora nodded. Together they said, "Eyes look, ears hear, gentle hands stay near." Jo pointed - not too close - to three ants carrying crumbs.
- 9.** The ants followed one another toward a crack in the path. Nora drew three dashes in box three. "They found a way home," Jo said.
- 10.** One box was still empty. The sky turned from bright to dim. A cool puff brushed Nora's cheek. Leaves flipped their pale undersides. "Rain is coming," Mama said.
- 11.** Plink! One drop landed inside box four. Plink-plink! Nora laughed. "The rain noticed my notebook!" They hurried home together - no butterfly, but four true surprises.
- 12.** By the window, Nora showed Jo every mark: one swirl, one circle, three dashes, and one raindrop. Then a blue butterfly crossed the garden - and kept flying. Nora smiled. "I noticed."

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